

Your Strategy

If this is the case for you, and you are being threatened by a creditor or a collection agency for old debts, or debts very near the end of the statute of limitations period, sit tight and zip your lip. You may be able to eliminate 100% of your debt by following Thomas Jefferson's words of wisdom: Remain always cool and unruffled under all circumstances.

When the telephone rings, many people who are being bothered by debt collectors stare at the phone with a fear in their eyes, afraid to pick it up. You don't have to be like that. This is not a horror movie. The boogie man is not going to reach through the phone and strangle you.

The debt collector wants you to think that he has that kind of power over you, but he does not. This is not a movie; this is your life, and you have the starring role. The debt collector does not even get a mention in the footnotes of your life. Do not let the collection agencies rule your life. Remember when you were a small toddler, you would march around and say, "I am the boss of me"? Well, you still are the boss of you, so when the telephone rings, remember that you have the upper hand.

Fear Not

Ring. There it is. The telephone. You, without a quiver of fear in your voice, say a very strong "hello." Tell yourself that the debt collector is just a scavenger who bought your debt for a pittance, sometimes as little as three cents on the dollar! He knows your debt is old. He is hoping that you don't have a clue.

But you do have a clue. You have a book of knowledge. You know the debt is old, that the statute of limitations has passed, so all you have to do is tell the collector that the account is no longer collectible. Click. That was you, hanging up.

Even if you are not sure if the debt is "time-barred," which means the statute has passed and they cannot collect, you need to remember that the collectors are foragers, scrounging around for a crumb, and they lie, cheat, and steal to get it. They may be trying to collect on an account that is indeed too old. You are now smart enough to know that you should